

▲ **By The Way...**

You can adjust just how the computer responds to double-clicks in the General Control Panel. If you tend to double-click very quickly, but the computer is expecting you to double-click slowly, you may find it occasionally registering double-clicks when you don't mean them. If you double-click slowly, and the computer is set for fast double-clicks, the computer may interpret your double-clicks as two separate clicks.

Shift-Clicking

Shift-clicking means you hold down the Shift key on the keyboard while clicking. This is often used to select a group of icons, or a number of items from a list, or a series of words in a word processor. There's also Apple-clicking, Command-clicking (the same as an Apple-click—that weird propeller symbol is Apple-speak for "command"), Option-clicking, and Control-clicking; different programs define these in different ways.

Cursors

The IIGS uses several different cursors to give you clues about what various mouse actions will do in a particular program. A cursor is just a more generic word for the on-screen pointer you're already familiar with—the arrow is just one cursor, though it's probably the most common one. The cursor changes when you move it from one type of area into another on the screen—for example, from an arrow to an I-beam when you move it into a text area and back to an arrow when you move it out of the text area. Visual feedback like this always lets you know what will happen when you click (or drag, or double-click, or...) and lets you know instantly when a program expects a certain kind of action.

The Arrow



The Arrow cursor appears when you're selecting items from a menu, when you can click on buttons in dialogs, and in places like the Finder where you can select and double-click icons. (In some drawing programs, you can select an object in your drawing with an arrow cursor.) Single-clicking selects an object; shift-clicking is used to select more than one object; double-clicking opens the object. In many programs (like the Finder) you can drag a rectangle around a group of objects to select them all. The arrow's hot spot—the point that determines where the computer thinks you're pointing—is at its tip.

The I-Beam



The I-Beam cursor appears in word processing documents and whenever the cursor is over a part of the screen where text can be entered. Clicking the mouse positions the insertion point; shift-clicking selects text from the insertion point to the cursor; double-clicking selects a word. The i-beam's hot spot is in the center of the vertical bar.